

# WILL MCGOWAN

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## EDUCATION

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**University of Strathclyde, Glasgow**

Sep 2023 - Jun 2027 (expected)

BA (Hons) Economics

- Average grade to date: 2:1
- **Relevant Modules:** Portfolio Management and Security Analysis; Applied Econometrics; Industrial Economics

**Dissertation** | MATLAB

In progress, due 2027

*"Does the News Pay? Forecasting European Gas Volatility with MIDAS, Storage and Text Data"*

- Testing whether news attention improves forecasts of TTF gas price volatility with mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models built on daily storage, market and news data, including an original Google Trends attention index
- Benchmarking out-of-sample against HAR and AR models and measuring economic value through the Sharpe ratio of a volatility-targeted TTF futures strategy

**Empirical CAPM Test**

MATLAB, Python

- Tested CAPM on 704 anomaly portfolios across 56 countries (JKP global factor data) using OLS and Newey-West t-tests and the GRS joint test
- Found the CAPM fails jointly in 48 of 52 countries; momentum (37 of 55 countries) and value (31 of 54) earned the most persistent alphas, size almost none (4 of 56)

**Monte Carlo Option Pricing Engine**

MATLAB, Python

- Priced European and Asian options by simulation; a geometric-Asian control variate reduced the standard error of arithmetic-Asian estimates by 97.24% vs plain Monte Carlo

**Belfast Royal Academy, Belfast**

Jun 2023

- A-levels: Mathematics (A), Economics (A), Computer Science (B)

## WORK EXPERIENCE

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**Le Set, Glasgow** | Head Mixologist

Sep 2026 - Present

- Created 4 original house cocktails and wrote the specifications for the 7 classics on the menu of a new 200-cover restaurant and cocktail lounge, opened Sep 2026
- Wrote batch specifications for 5 prebatched cocktails and trained around 15 bar staff to prepare and serve them consistently

**KONG, Glasgow** | Mixologist and Front of House

Oct 2024 - Jun 2026

- Analysed sales patterns to refine guest-facing upselling prompts, raising average customer spend by an estimated 25%
- Reconciled cash and card takings at the end of each shift

## LEADERSHIP AND ACTIVITIES

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**Strathclyde Agricapital Society** | Co-Founder and Treasurer

Sep 2025 - Present

- Co-founded the university's first agri-finance society, grew membership to 126 and led weekly research sessions on deals such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC
- Built a wheat calendar-spread strategy in R (weekly backtest: Sharpe 0.28 after costs, maximum drawdown 3.1%) and published weekly research notes for members

**Strathclyde Poker Society** | Vice-President, then President

Sep 2025 - Apr 2026

- Ran weekly tournaments for around 60 players on a £600-per-semester budget, reconciling every buy-in and prize pool

## ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

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**Technical:** R, MATLAB, Python, Excel, Git

**Interests:** chess, 14th at the Irish U19 Chess Championships (2023) and won 21 of 22 games in a simultaneous exhibition against players averaging 1860 FIDE; powerlifting, Northern Ireland U19 champion (2023)